

. RBIM — Relationship Boundary Integrity Module

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Subcategory:AccountabilityGovernanceArchitecture
Type:RelationshipAccountabilityStandardModule
ParentStandard:RelationshipAccountabilityStandard(RAS) **Version:1.0**
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Compatibility:AccountabilityGovernanceArchitecture(AGA™)·RelationshipAccountabilityStandard(RAS)·Authority
GovernanceStandard(AGS)·ResponsibilityGovernanceStandard(RGS)·ChainofControlStandard(CCS)
AI-Readable:Yes Authority:OOF

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Canonical Definition

RelationshipBoundaryIntegrityModule(RBIM)definesthestructuralconditionsunderwhichtheboundaries,limits,scope,andgovernanceextentofrelationshipsremainidentifiable,distinguishable,traceable,governable,andoperationallyvalidthroughouttherelationshiplifecycle.
RBIMgovernsrelationshipboundaries.

Themoduleestablishestheconditionsrequiredtodeterminewherearerelationshipbegins,whereitends,whatitincludes,whatitexcludes,andhowfargovernanceobligationsextendacrossparticipatingactors.

Module Operational Role

RBIMservesastheboundary-governancelayeroftheRelationshipAccountabilityStandard.
Itsroleistodefinethelimitsofrelationshipsbeforeauthority,responsibility,capability,control,oversight,evidence,andaccountabilityanalysisproceeds. RBIManswersthequestion:

Module Operational Space

RBIMgoverns: relationshipboundaries relationshipscope
governanceboundaries operationallimits participationlimits
inclusioncriteria exclusioncriteria
boundarytraceability Themoduleapplieswherevergovernancerequiresclearrelationshiplimits.

Module Function

Themoduleensuresthatgovernancecandetermine:
whoisinsidetherelationship whoisoutsidetherelationship
whatactivitiesarecovered whatactivitiesareexcluded

where governance obligations start where governance obligations stop
where relationship influence begins
where relationship influence ends Its function is to prevent governance ambiguity caused by unclear relationship boundaries.

Minimum Implementation Framework

1. Define Relationship Scope

Determine the intended scope of the relationship. Examples:
employment relationship contractor relationship supplier relationship
supervisory relationship Human-AI relationship multi-agent relationship

2. Identify Included Actors

Identify all actors operating within the relationship boundary. Examples:
individuals organizations contractors subcontractors
AI agents robotics systems

3. Identify Excluded Actors

Determine which actors remain outside the relationship boundary.
Governance must distinguish between: participating actors
non-participating actors indirect actors external actors

4. Validate Boundary Accuracy

Determine whether documented boundaries reflect operational reality.
Governance must identify: hidden extensions undeclared participation
informal influence boundary expansion boundary contraction

5. Preserve Boundary

Traceability Maintains sufficient evidence to reconstruct relationship boundaries throughout governance analysis.

Use Case 1 — Multi-Layer Contractor Environment

Scenario

A company contracts a supplier, who contracts a subcontractor, who contracts a staffing agency.

Application

RBIM determines which actors fall within the operational relationship boundary and where governance obligations extend.

Result Governance gains a clear understanding of relationship limits across the operational chain.

Use Case 2 — Human-AI Operational Environment

Scenario

A human operator supervises an orchestration system controlling multiple AI agents and robotics systems.

Application

RBIM determines the governance boundaries of participation, supervision, and operational influence.

Result Governance gains visibility into the limits of the operational relationship structure.

Canonical Closing Statement

Relationship Boundary Integrity Module (RBIM) defines the structural conditions under which the boundaries, limits, scope, and governance extent of relationships remain identifiable, distinguishable, traceable, governable, and

operationally valid throughout the relationship lifecycle.

Governance cannot determine obligations if relationship boundaries remain unclear. Relationship boundary integrity therefore becomes a foundational condition of accountability governance.

Related Documents

→ [Relationship Accountability Standard - \(RAS\)](#)

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